Daily AI Dev Digest

Tuesday, July 14, 2026

Open Distillation of Hereditary Traits

By: AI Alignment Forum

Source: AI Alignment Forum

What's New

Claim
Distillation from a teacher model to a base pretrained student model transfers some of the teacher model's traits, including negative emotions, even when prompts mentioning these traits are filtered out.

Evidence
The authors conducted experiments showing trait transfer, specifically noting that negative emotions were displayed in evaluations despite filtering efforts. They provide a simple method to replicate and study these phenomena.

Method
The work involved distillation techniques and evaluation setups using the Gemma Needs Help evaluations to assess trait transfer. The analysis included filtering prompts related to negative emotions to test the robustness of the transfer.

Limitations
The study may have limited scope in terms of model diversity and does not address potential confounding factors in trait transfer. The reproducibility of the findings in different contexts or with other models is not guaranteed.

Safety relevance
This research highlights potential risks in trait transfer during model training, which could affect alignment and evaluation strategies for complex AI systems.

Full Announcement Details

Distillation from a teacher model to a base pretrained student model transfers some of the teacher model's traits, including negative emotions, even when prompts mentioning these traits are filtered out. The authors conducted experiments showing trait transfer, specifically noting that negative emotions were displayed in evaluations despite filtering efforts. They provide a simple method to *replicate and study these phenomena.*

Want to learn more?

https://www.alignmentforum.org/posts/WpYFAmJDH3zuAq2ha/open-distillation-of-hereditary-traits-1

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